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Elon Musk's Boring Company to build Tesla tunnels under Nashville

The Boring Company, Elon Musk's tunnel-digging company, and Tennessee Governor Bill Lee have [announced](#) a plan to build a 10-mile "loop" that will connect Nashville's downtown and its convention center.

The project is a competitive bid. The Governor's office is partnering with local officials to evaluate the project's initial impact.

Construction of the project is expected to be operational as "early as fall of 2026."

If that happens, Nashville would become the second city where The Boring Company has opened such a system, with the first being Las Vegas. The company has spent the last few years in Sin City digging and opening tunnels around the Las Vegas Convention Center, and claims to have given 3 million rides in Teslas to date.

Musk launched The Boring Company [in early 2017](#) (after publicly noodling about the idea on Twitter while stuck in traffic in late 2016), and it has taken many forms since then.

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The original video detailing Musk’s idea — now set to private on YouTube — showed vehicles getting removed from surface street gridlock by an elevator-meets-sled system and lowered into a three-dimensional underground network of tunnels. Musk also claimed during the first Trump administration that The Boring Company had received “verbal govt approval” to dig tunnels from New York City to Washington, D.C. that, leveraging hyperloop technology, could make the trip in just 29 minutes.

None of that ever happened. The Boring Company abandoned plans to dig a major tunnel system underneath the greater Los Angeles area after

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mover, although there are some potential benefits to its approach versus the typical monorail setup. Construction should be less disruptive to Nashville’s daily traffic. And, in its current form at least, it’s not costing taxpayers money.

While the Tennessee governor’s office cites The Boring Company’s safety record in Las Vegas in the announcement — the loop “recently earned a 99.57% safety and security rating” from the Department of Homeland Security and Transportation Security Administration, according to the press release — it is careful not to mention the trouble that Musk’s tunnel-digging effort has

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experienced during construction. (The governor's office could not be reached for comment.)

Like with [other Musk companies](#), the pace at which The Boring Company operates — the same speed that the Tennessee governor's office praised in its announcement — has been a concern for some of its workers.

Last year, Fortune's Jessica Mathews [reported](#) that a Boring Company employee told his then-safety manager: "I have watched my friends get injured due to the fast pace we've been running... I refuse to be the first fatality in this company's history. No tunnel is worth a single person's life."

That said, on the road, he told to visitors he couldn't

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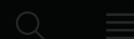
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Here's our first look at
Elon Musk's Boring Co.

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Elon Musk is digging a tunnel under Hawthorne near SpaceX headquarters in California, after receiving approval from city council to do so. Musk's Boring Co. has already made considerable progress on the dig and tunnel build, apparently, as Musk shared an image of the tunnel from the inside showing a reinforced tube that stretches off into the distance out of sight.

The tunnel features paneled walls, cables and a large upper conduit, as well as lighting and what appear to be tracks. The tunnel just outside of LA is the first the Boring Co. has undertaken, but it recently received provisional approval to start

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digging in Maryland, too, on a second test dig that will potentially become part of an underground Hyperloop network.

Musk's LA tunnel is a pilot project designed to test the feasibility of his plan to dig tunnels at a lower cost and more efficiently than current tunnel boring companies operate, with the eventual aim of supplying cities and regions with underground tunnel networks that can transport goods and services while avoiding surface obstacles and traffic.

The Boring Co. is still a long way from achieving the grand vision of constructing inter-city underground

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Elon Musk's Boring Co.

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Elon Musk's The Boring Company, which he dreamed up while sitting in traffic in LA because he wanted to go *under* said traffic, has permission to dig a two-mile test tunnel in Hawthorne, California just outside LA. The approval for the test dig comes from the Hawthorne City Council, which voted four to one in favor of the move, according to [The Verge](#). It's not a [cross-country Hyperloop network](#), but it's a start.

Musk's SpaceX has its own headquarters in Hawthorne, and thus far all The Boring Company's

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digging activity has taken place only on company territory. But The Boring Co. will now extend its tunnel out into city property, all at a depth of 44 feet below the Earth's surface.

Nothing sits on the planned path above the tunnel to be dug, which is likely for the best, since the whole point is to try out the tunnel boring system to see if it works as planned. It's also not necessarily going to be used post-dig, as SpaceX has told the city it can ask that it be filled in with either dirt or a "concrete slurry" according to The Verge.

The goal is that the digging take place without any noticeable disturbance to anyone on the surface

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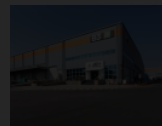
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